

Table 1

Real-time application	Use cases
Customer support centres	Technical support, product suggestions, discount offerings, churn prediction
Automotive sector	Taxi ordering, self-driving cars, voice-assisted systems, car diagnostics, customer support
E-commerce	Product recommendations, tracking buyers' purchases, store management, customer feedback support systems
Travel	Vacation planning and recommendations, reservations, expense management, local insider guide, customer queries and complaints handling
Finance	Financial advisor information services, investment management, stock exchange investment support, credit applications, money transfers, bill payments, banking bots, taxation planning and management, insurance policy management
Healthcare	Ongoing health monitoring, patient management, appointment scheduling, patient support and administration, research and treatment, drug recommendations, medical equipment recommender systems
Media and entertainment	News delivery, user satisfaction surveys, selling merchandise, onsite personalisation

technologies is already overwhelming and growing each day. With chatbot applications, chatbot builders, social messaging platforms, chatbot analytics, and natural language processing (NLP) and machine learning (ML) tools, there is a lot one needs to wrap one's head around prior to deciding on the best chatbot platform. Lots of commercial and open source options are available. In this article, we list the top open source chatbot development platforms that developers can choose from, based on their requirements and area of expertise, to develop efficient chatbots for enterprises and other clients.

Botkit

Botkit is regarded as a leading open source development tool for building chatbots, apps and custom integrations for major messaging platforms; it was built by Howdy in Austin, Texas in the US. It provides a strong base for developers to make bots for Facebook Messenger, Slack, Twilio and many more platforms. Botkit provides a strong platform to create intelligent conversational applications that map the way real humans speak.

It includes a variety of useful tools like Botkit Studio, boilerplate app starter kits, a core library, and plugins to extend the bot's capabilities. Botkit is built on Node.js, making it developer friendly. The Botkit platform supports natural language

understanding through the use of middleware, and supports IBM Watson conversation service, Microsoft LUIS, API.AI, Recast.AI and wit.AI.

Core features

- Eases the process of designing and running bots that reside inside Slack, as it provides a semantic interface to send and receive messages so that developers can focus on creating novel applications and experience
- Built-in stats and metrics
- Powerful open source libraries
- Fully-featured SDK with support for all major platforms
- Consists of content management, design tools along with plugins and middleware

Latest version: 0.6.19

Official website: <https://botkit.ai/>

Botpress

Botpress is an open source bot development platform written in Typescript. It consists of various open source modules built by the community. It is lightweight, blazing fast and has zero system dependencies except Node.js. Botpress includes modules for both Messenger and Slack, so the developer has to just swap one module for another, while the rest of the implementation stays the same.

The backend of Botpress runs on Node.js and SQLite and, in the near

future, PostgreSQL will be available. The frontend of Botpress runs on React/Redux/Bootstrap, and consists of all sorts of cool libs like Socket.IO, Lodash, Axios, JWT, Knex and Bluebird.

Components of Botpress

- Flow Editor - Flexible conversational flow management system
- NLU - Understands the definition and intent behind every message
- Analytics - Makes bots intelligent from time to time
- Multi-channel - Compatible with popular messaging apps
- Authoring UI - GUI interface
- SDKs and APIs - Extensible and customisable

Core features

- Available under AGPL and Botpress proprietary licence
- Easy to learn and developer friendly
- Code-first bot building framework
- Modular design via specialised open source modules and free to most users
- Highly productive and extensible

Latest version: 10.50.0

Official website: <https://botpress.io/>

BotMan

BotMan is a PHP chatbot framework designed for task simplification in order to develop innovative chatbots